

**Van Trampers South Island Safari**  
**1 February to 13 March 2027**  
**SUMMARY**



| #  | Locality (Site ID)                      | Options                                                                                                        | Nights | Dates                                |
|----|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------------------------------------|
| 1  | Reefton (START)<br><b>6531</b>          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Overnight Tramp</li> <li>Heritage/History</li> </ul> | 3      | Arr Feb 1<br>Dep Feb 4               |
| 2  | Denniston<br><b>6455</b>                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Heritage/History</li> </ul>                          | 2      | Arr Feb 4<br>Dep Feb 6               |
| 3  | Westport<br><b>6479</b>                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> </ul>                                                    | 2      | Arr Feb 6<br>Dep Feb 8 Waitangi Day  |
| 4  | Fox River<br><b>6507</b>                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Overnight Tramp</li> </ul>                           | 2      | Arr Feb 8 Waitangi Day<br>Dep Feb 10 |
| 5  | Greymouth<br><b>6635</b>                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Heritage/History</li> </ul>                          | 2      | Arr Feb 10<br>Dep Feb 12             |
| 6  | Lake Kaniere<br><b>6727</b>             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Overnight Tramp</li> </ul>                           | 2      | Arr Feb 12<br>Dep 14                 |
| 7  | Arthurs Pass<br><b>7682</b>             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Overnight Tramp</li> </ul>                           | 2      | Arr Feb 14<br>Dep Feb 16             |
| 8  | Hawdon Valley<br><b>7676</b>            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Overnight Tramp</li> </ul>                           | 4      | Arr Feb 16<br>Dep Feb 20             |
| 9  | Cass<br><b>7680</b>                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> </ul>                                                    | 2      | Arr Feb 20<br>Dep Feb 21             |
| 10 | Oxford<br><b>7488/7480</b>              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Overnight Tramp</li> </ul>                           | 7      | Arr Feb 21<br>Dep Feb 28             |
| 11 | Lake Coleridge<br><b>7695/7694</b>      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Heritage/History</li> </ul>                          | 3      | Arr Feb 28<br>Dep Mar 3              |
| 12 | Methven<br><b>7730</b>                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> </ul>                                                    | 1      | Arr Mar 3<br>Dep Mar 4               |
| 13 | Mt Somers<br><b>7828/7813/7810/7807</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Overnight Tramp</li> </ul>                           | 3      | Arr Mar 4<br>Dep Mar 7               |
| 14 | Hakatere<br><b>8014</b>                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> </ul>                                                    | 3      | Arr Mar 7<br>Dep Mar 10              |
| 15 | Geraldine (FINISH)<br><b>7880</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Day Walks</li> <li>Heritage/History</li> </ul>                          | 3      | Arr Mar 10<br>Dep Mar 13             |

## How We Roll

Our South Island Safari is based around 15 geographical localities over six weeks; we hope that gives us enough time to explore each area.

This is a flexible trip, not a guided tour. Everything is optional, and everyone is free to choose activities that suit their interests, fitness, energy levels and the weather.

Each hub offers a menu of possibilities, including day walks, occasional bike rides, opportunities for kayaking, and for those keen, a selection of overnight or multi-day tramps. The programme is designed to provide choices rather than a fixed schedule.

Each evening at Happy Hour we'll discuss the following day's options, decide who wants to do what, organise transport where needed, and naturally split into smaller groups.

Some overnight tramps may require vehicle shuttles, drop-offs or van relocations. Those interested should start discussing plans well in advance via our WhatsApp group and/or at our rallies so hut bookings, transport and other logistics can be organised. The tramps are often the easy part—the logistics usually take the most planning!

Weather will play a major role in our day-to-day decisions, so plans may change at short notice. Parking restrictions may also mean we are spread over more than one location in some towns, but we'll stay connected through WhatsApp.

To help with fuel and transport costs, a taxi-van contribution of **\$4 per person, per leg** is proposed (TBC).

Lay days may sometimes coincide with travel days between hubs or provide an opportunity for shorter walks, local sightseeing or simply relaxing. We also expect to enjoy the occasional meal out together.

Above all, the Safari is about good company, shared adventure, flexibility and the freedom for everyone to enjoy the journey in their own way.